

Periodic Assessment — CA-1

Class 5 · CBSE / NCERT · 2026-27

Class:	5	Subject:	EVS
Max Marks:	70	Duration:	2 Hr 30 Min
Name:	_____	Roll No:	_____
Date:	_____	Difficulty:	Medium

Syllabus: Units 1-3 — Water: The Essence of Life, Journey of a River, The Mystery of Food, Our School: A Happy Place, Our Vibrant Country, Some Unique Places

ANSWER KEY

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1 Mark each)

1. Which process describes water vapour turning into tiny water droplets to form clouds? (1 Mark)

A. Evaporation	B. Condensation ✓
C. Precipitation	D. Pollution

2. A small stream that joins a larger river is called a _____. (1 Mark)

A. delta	B. tributary ✓
C. glacier	D. canal

3. Which nutrient mainly helps in building and repairing our body's muscles? (1 Mark)

A. Carbohydrates	B. Protein ✓
C. Vitamin C	D. Water

4. Which of these is the best way to preserve food for a longer time at home? (1 Mark)

A. Leaving it uncovered on the table	B. Refrigerating or drying it properly ✓
C. Keeping it in sunlight all day	D. Mixing it with soil

5. What is the main purpose of school rules such as standing in a queue or maintaining silence in class? (1 Mark)

A. To trouble students	B. To keep order, safety and respect among everyone ✓
C. To waste time	D. To punish students

6. India is often called a land of "unity in diversity" mainly because _____. (1 Mark)

A. everyone speaks the same language	B. people of many religions, languages and cultures live together as one nation ✓
C. only one festival is celebrated	D. all states have the same food

7. Which of these Indian sites is known as a natural wonder rather than a man-made monument? (1 Mark)

A. Red Fort	B. Thar Desert ✓
C. Qutub Minar	D. India Gate

8. Which river is often called the "lifeline" of northern India because millions depend on it? (1 Mark)

A. Godavari	B. Ganga ✓
C. Kaveri	D. Narmada

9. Why do many old wells and step-wells dry up or get polluted in cities today? (1 Mark)

A. Because of too much rain	B. Because of over-use, garbage dumping and lack of care ✓
C. Because they were never useful	D. Because rivers stopped flowing

SECTION B — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks each)

1. Explain the difference between fresh water and saline water with one example each. (2 Marks)

➤ Fresh water has very little salt and is fit to drink, for example river water. Saline water has a lot of dissolved salt and is not fit for drinking, for example sea water.

2. Why do rivers usually flow faster in the mountains and slower in the plains? (2 Marks)

➤ In the mountains the land is steep, so the river flows down quickly over rocks; in the plains the land is flatter, so the river slows down and spreads out.

3. Give two reasons why junk food is not considered part of a balanced diet. (2 Marks)

➤ Junk food usually has too much oil, sugar or salt and very few vitamins or minerals, so it does not give the body all the nutrients it needs and can make a person unhealthy over time.

4. How does eating clean, properly cooked food protect us from falling ill? (2 Marks)

➤ Cooking and cleaning food kills germs that could cause stomach infections, so eating clean, well-cooked food lowers the chance of catching diseases spread through food.

5. Explain how cooperation among students and teachers makes a school a happy place. (2 Marks)

➤ When students help each other, listen to teachers, and teachers guide students kindly, everyone feels supported, which makes the school a pleasant and happy place to be in.

6. Give two examples of India's cultural diversity that you have noticed. (2 Marks)

➤ India has many languages, such as Hindi, Tamil and Bengali, and many festivals, such as Diwali, Eid and Christmas, celebrated by people across the country.

7. Why do old monuments like forts and temples need to be protected and preserved? (2 Marks)

➤ These monuments show the history, art and skill of earlier generations, so protecting them helps future generations learn about the past and keeps our heritage alive.

8. Explain briefly what causes river water pollution near cities. (2 Marks)

➤ River water gets polluted when factories release chemical waste and people dump garbage or untreated sewage directly into the river, making the water unsafe for drinking or aquatic life.

9. What role do national symbols like the flag and the national anthem play for citizens of a country? (2 Marks)
- National symbols give citizens a shared sense of identity and pride, reminding everyone that despite differences, they belong to one nation.
10. How is food from plants different from food that comes from animals? Give one example each. (2 Marks)
- Food from plants, like rice or spinach, comes from crops and vegetables we grow, while food from animals, like milk or eggs, comes from animals we rear.
11. Explain why hill stations are popular tourist destinations in India. (2 Marks)
- Hill stations have cool weather, green forests and beautiful scenery, which makes them a pleasant escape from the heat, attracting many tourists especially in summer.
12. How can students at school help conserve water? (2 Marks)
- Students can turn off taps tightly after use, report leaking taps to teachers, and avoid wasting water while washing hands or during activities.
13. What is meant by a "delta" in the context of a river's journey? (2 Marks)
- A delta is the triangular area formed where a river splits into several smaller streams before finally meeting the sea, often depositing fertile soil there.
14. Why is it important for a country to have people from different backgrounds working and studying together, as seen in schools? (2 Marks)
- It helps children learn to respect different cultures and ideas from a young age, and prepares them to live and work well with all kinds of people later in life.

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (Explain) (3 Marks each)

1. Explain the complete journey of a river from its source to the sea, mentioning at least three stages. (3 Marks)
- A river usually begins as melting snow or a spring in the mountains, forming a fast-flowing narrow stream.
 - As it moves down, smaller streams called tributaries join it, making it wider and slower on the plains.
 - Finally, it reaches the sea, sometimes forming a delta where it splits into several channels before joining the ocean.
2. Discuss why a balanced diet is more important for growing children than for adults. (3 Marks)
- Children's bodies are still growing, so they need proteins for muscle and bone development and vitamins for a strong immune system.
 - A lack of proper nutrition at this age can affect a child's height, strength and ability to concentrate in school.
 - Adults, while still needing balanced food, are not growing as fast, so the impact of poor diet is somewhat different.
3. Explain, with examples, how schools help students learn values beyond just academic subjects. (3 Marks)
- Schools teach students to cooperate through group activities and sports, and to be disciplined by following rules like being on time.
 - Celebrating festivals of different communities in school teaches respect for diversity.
 - These experiences shape good habits and values that help students throughout their life, not just in exams.
4. How does India's geography contribute to it having many "unique places" such as deserts, backwaters and hill stations? (3 Marks)
- India is a very large country with mountains in the north, plains in the middle, deserts in the west, and coastlines with backwaters in the south.
 - This variety in land and climate creates very different kinds of unique places within one country.
 - That is why a visitor can see snow-capped mountains and hot deserts within the same nation.

5. Discuss two ways in which pollution of rivers affects both people and animals. (3 Marks)

- Polluted river water can cause diseases in people who drink it or use it for cooking and bathing.
- Fish and other water animals can die or become unsafe to eat if the water contains harmful chemicals or garbage.
- This shows that keeping rivers clean is important for the health of both humans and wildlife.

6. Explain why preserving old monuments is considered important for a country's identity, using one Indian example. (3 Marks)

- Monuments like the Taj Mahal or the Red Fort tell the story of India's history, rulers and craftsmanship from long ago.
- If such monuments are not preserved, future generations would lose an important way of understanding their own history and culture.
- They also bring tourism and pride to the country, making their protection doubly important.

SECTION D — Long Answer / Descriptive Questions (5 Marks each)

1. Explain the water cycle in detail and describe two ways in which human activities can disturb it. (5 Marks)

- The water cycle involves evaporation of water from oceans and rivers due to the sun's heat, condensation of vapour into clouds, and precipitation as rain or snow that returns water to the Earth.
- This water then flows into rivers and the ground, continuing the cycle endlessly.
- Human activities like cutting down forests reduce the amount of water plants release into the air, disturbing rainfall patterns.
- Pollution of water bodies and excessive use of groundwater can also reduce the amount of clean water available for the cycle to work properly.

2. Describe the main food groups that make up a balanced diet and explain what would happen if a person ate only one food group for a long time. (5 Marks)

- A balanced diet includes carbohydrates (rice, wheat) for energy, proteins (dal, eggs, milk) for growth, fats in small amounts, and vitamins and minerals from fruits and vegetables.
- If a person ate only one food group, for example only carbohydrates, they might get enough energy but would lack protein for growth and vitamins to fight disease.
- Over time this can lead to weakness, poor growth, and illnesses caused by nutrient deficiency.
- This is why doctors and elders always advise eating a mix of different foods every day.

3. India is known for its unity in diversity. Explain this idea using examples from languages, festivals and geography, and describe why it is considered a strength of the country. (5 Marks)

- India has people speaking many languages such as Hindi, Bengali, Tamil and Punjabi, and following different religions who celebrate festivals like Diwali, Eid, Christmas and Baisakhi.
- Geographically too, India has deserts, mountains, plains and coasts, home to different communities with their own customs.
- Despite all these differences, people identify as one nation, united under symbols like the National Flag and shared national days like Independence Day.
- This diversity, combined with unity, is considered a strength because it brings together many ideas, skills and traditions, making the country richer in culture.